



ASK NOW

India is dogged by a lack of clarity in its preparedness and response to the nefarious designs of terrorists. The War on Terror needs that definition of purpose and specific goals. INDIA TODAY's panel of experts addresses that need, answering reader's queries and offering solutions.



LALIT MANSINGH
Former foreign secretary

Can a pre-emptive strike against Pak lead to a war?

JEHAN, (jehan.nathan@gmail.com)

There is a real danger that even a limited strike on terrorist camps can escalate into a full-fledged war. Pakistan has deep internal divisions and serious problems—insurgency in Baluchistan, increasing influence of the Pakistani Taliban and a grave financial crisis. A military action also poses the threat of a military take-over of Pakistan, and remember that it also has nukes.



B. RAMAN
Former additional secretary R&AW

What are the reasons for lack of coordination among the intelligence agencies?

MIKE, (mikedixon55@gmail.com)

Lack of coordination is due to ego clashes, the culture of over-secrecy and the inability of the chiefs to instill in their officers the realisation that all of them are working and fighting for a common cause. We do not have a culture of joint action, otherwise, the IB, the R&AW and the navy would not be blaming each other.



KAPIL KAK
Retired air marshal and joint director, Centre for Air Power Studies

Why is India allowing illegal immigrants from Pakistan and Bangladesh?

DHARMCHANDRA,

(dcagrawal007@yahoo.co.in)

I share your concern over illegal immigrants from the two countries. The Pakistanis could also be sleeper cells to be activated for terrorist operations. Due to vote bank politics, nearly 20 million immigrants from Bangladesh have acquired a degree of permanency in Assam. Government policies have been very lax in this regard.



GURMEET KANWAL
Retired brigadier and director of Centre for Land Warfare Studies

What is the solution to make the country safe?

SUDHIR, (sudhir.ksd@gmail.com)

The solution lies in enhancing our human intelligence capabilities by an order of magnitude, creating a suitable organisation to make intelligence assessments and fine-tuning our counter-terrorism response to react quickly and effectively. We should enhance counter-terrorism cooperation with friendly powers.

India's Views

Politicians should stop hurting people's religious sentiments. If we wish to curb corruption, young people will have to lead the nation. Our security personnel should be properly looked after and need to be armed well.

AKANKSHA HANS, *Delhi*

Be honest and elect honest people if you want the politicians to provide protection for you.

TUSHAR HINDOCHA, *Kolkata*

As Pakistan is a nuclear armed nation, India has to refrain from going to war yet show the world that it is taking Pakistan-sponsored terrorism seriously. India will have to recall its high commissioner in Islamabad, as well as ask the Pakistani high commissioner in Delhi to leave. We must break all diplomatic and trade ties with Pakistan.

THYAGARAJAN VELLORE SUNDARAVELU, *Chennai*

Are we still waiting for another terror attack? Pakistan is acting smart and this will not be accepted this time. Indians want to see action now. We can't keep quiet any more. The 9/11 attack against America started a war. Now no one dares touch that country. Do we need a reason to fight terrorism? We don't need permission from any other nation to save our country.

AMARDEEP JAIN, *Hyderabad*

We have been suffering from Pakistan-sponsored terrorism for a long time now. Our neighbouring country has become a factory of terrorists. That, terrorists' camps in PoK and Pakistan have the support of the ISI, Pakistani army as well its civilian government, is an open secret. All peace-loving nations must destroy Pakistan's nuclear arsenal. There is no point in believing that democracy in Pakistan will last long.

RAM VILASH BARI, *Hisar*

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